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REMARKABLE 2026

Event Recap - February 19-20, 2026

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AI Powers **Possibility**

Vector Institute's third annual Remarkable 2026 conference demonstrated how AI research powers real-world possibility, bringing together over 1,500 researchers and industry leaders to explore the transformative potential of Canada's collaborative AI ecosystem.

The two-day conference showcased this evolution through its distinctive structure: day one featured breakthrough research presentations and visionary industry perspectives that tackled the shift from "What can AI answer?" to "What can AI do?", while day two transformed these insights into actionable strategies through hands-on workshops focused on Privacy & Security, Agentic AI, and LLM Frontiers.

As the nexus where academic excellence meets industry innovation, Remarkable 2026 highlighted the unique advantages that emerge when researchers and practitioners collaborate to address AI's most critical implementation challenges. From government leaders affirming Canada's commitment to AI leadership to breakthrough presentations on video-based AI models and autonomous scientific discovery, the conference reinforced Canada's position at the forefront of responsible AI development.

Throughout both days, the community's collaborative energy and shared commitment to ethical AI deployment demonstrated how Vector's network of researchers, industry partners, and emerging talent is accelerating the translation of groundbreaking research into meaningful real-world impact.

1500+ attendees

39 countries represented

244K+ impressions

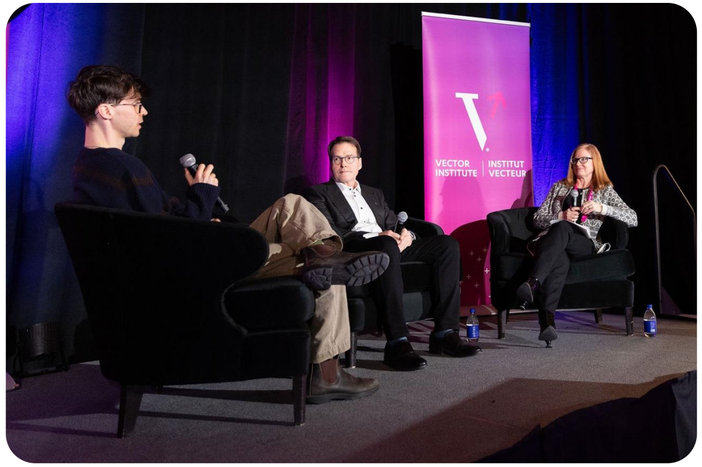
6 media outlets

30 large enterprise companies

20 thought-leading speakers


Remarkable 2026 | February 19, 2026
Fireside Chat
Glenda Crisp
President & CEO, Vector Institute
Nick Frosst
Co-Founder, Cohere
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GALLERY DEPT
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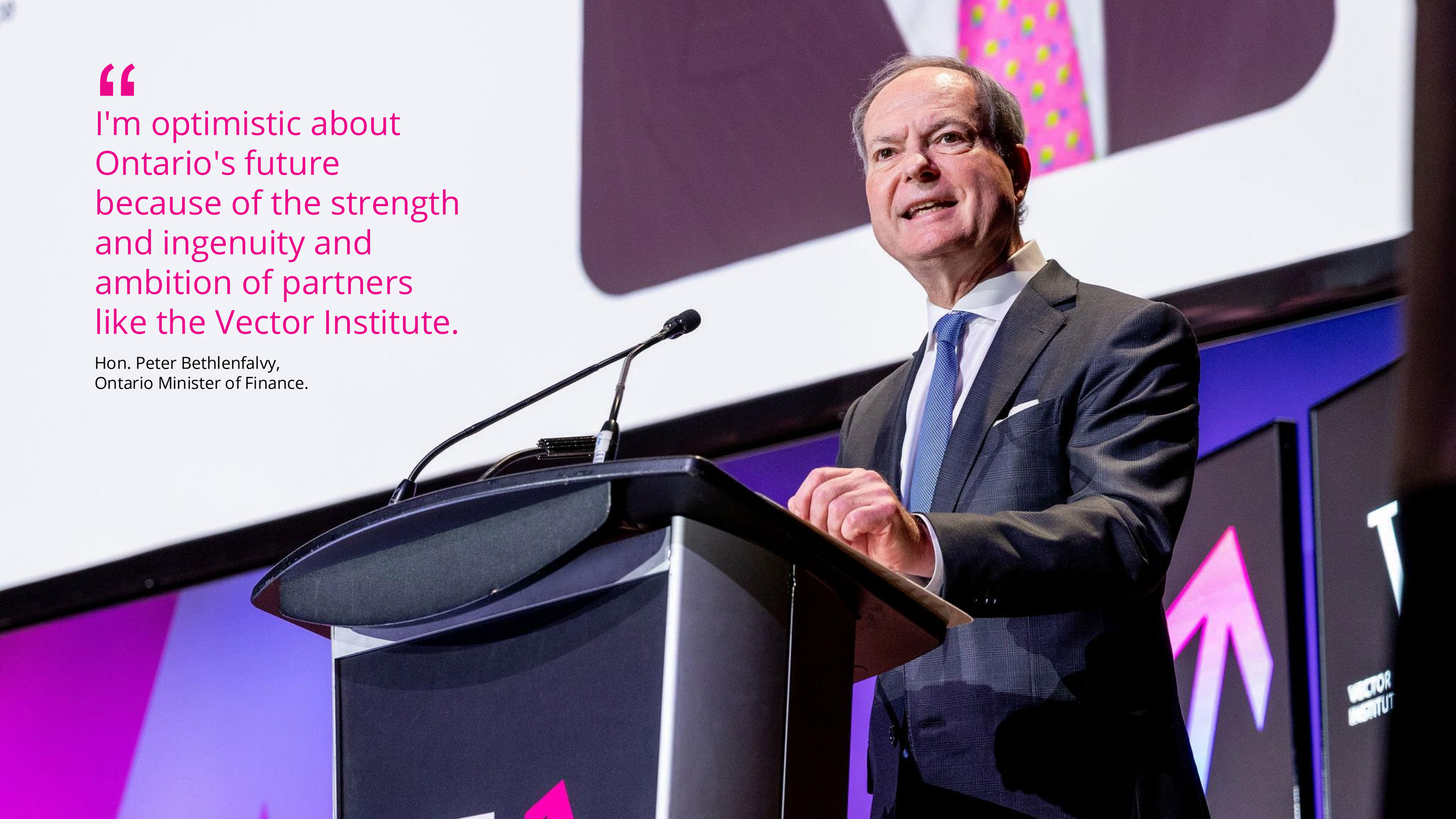
Remarkable 2026's opening day focused on what Canada must do to compete in AI and showcased cutting-edge research in the field.





It began with an exclusive executive breakfast attended by leaders from industry and government. The featured panel, "From Research to Reality: Canada's AI Leadership Imperative," was led by Vector's President & CEO **Glenda Crisp** and included **Nick Frosst**, co-founder of Canadian AI star **Cohere**, and **John Watson** Group President at **Bell Canada**, which has launched AI Fabric, an ambitious plan to build enough sovereign AI infrastructure to keep Canadian businesses competitive.

Frosst and Watson agreed that many of the technical challenges Canadian AI startups faced a few years ago, such as access to domestic computing power, have eased. The larger obstacles now, they said, are cultural and organizational, with AI adoption in Canada lagging behind competitors. Watson expressed optimism that the federal government will soon introduce bolder AI policies and said 2026 will be a year of tremendous opportunities for Canadian AI firms.



“

I'm optimistic about Ontario's future because of the strength and ingenuity and ambition of partners like the Vector Institute.

Hon. Peter Bethlenfalvy,
Ontario Minister of Finance.

The more than 1,500 researchers and industry leaders participating in the conference were then welcomed via video by Ontario Premier **Doug Ford**, who highlighted the potential of AI to grow the economy and improve people's lives. Ontario Finance Minister **Peter Bethlenfalvy** followed with an in-person address, noting that AI already supports more than 80,000 Ontario jobs and has attracted more than $10 billion in venture capital to the province. Bethlenfalvy told the conference Ontario remains committed to championing the AI sector and investing in the conditions that help it thrive.

Frosst then rejoined Crisp for a one-on-one conversation about why Cohere chose Canada and the broader potential of the country's AI ecosystem. He argued that growing disenchantment with Silicon Valley's vision for the future creates an opening for Canadian firms to lead. "We like Canada. It's a great place to start a company," he said.





Day 1 February 19, 2026

The remainder of the day featured presentations from leading researchers and industry executives.

Chris Maddison, Vector Faculty Member, Canada CIFAR AI Chair, and Assistant Professor at the University of Toronto, discussed how large language models (LLMs) are consuming data faster than new information is being produced and suggested ways to refine existing datasets to extract more value.

Ankita Upadhyay of **Thomson Reuters** emphasized the need for guardrails around agentic AI to protect people from harm and businesses from costly mistakes.

Priyank Jaini of **Google DeepMind** demonstrated how video-based AI models can outperform LLMs on certain tasks, including puzzle-solving and understanding how objects behave under different gravitational conditions.

Vector Faculty Member, Canada CIFAR AI Chair, and University of Toronto professor **Alán Aspuru-Guzik** discussed El Agente, an LLM-powered multi-agent system designed to accelerate scientific discovery and now capable of answering PhD-level questions independently.









Day 2 February 20, 2026

The conference’s second day was all about turning research into action.

Three workshops on key issues facing AI adoption took place, featuring expert speakers and breakout sessions where conference attendees could share their views and offer solutions — offering a unique opportunity for collaboration between Vector’s industry and research communities.



1. Agentic AI

The **Agentic AI** workshop focused on bridging the gap between autonomous AI research and practical deployment, featuring insights from Vector Faculty Member **Xiaoxiao Li**, Vector’s **Amrit Krishnan**, and **Dana Sharp** of **Linamar Corporation**. Sessions examined critical evaluation frameworks that assess agents at the trajectory level, practical approaches to measuring performance in production environments, and industry perspectives that highlighted real-world successes, such as Vector's collaboration with Linamar on custom manufacturing agents — early deployments saw approximately $100,000 in cost savings, demonstrating how research-industry partnerships translate autonomous AI innovations into measurable business impact.



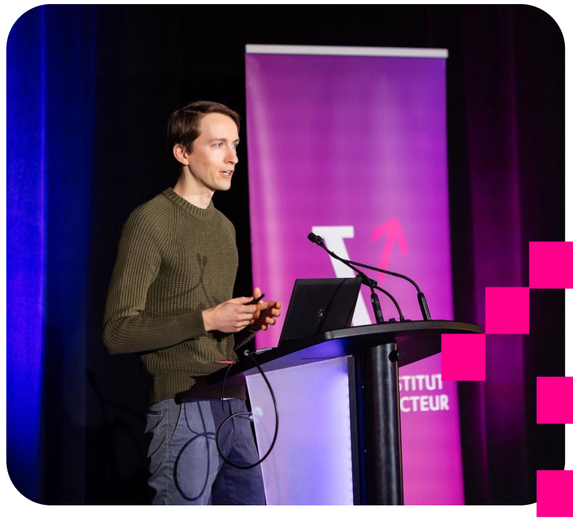
2. Privacy & Security

The **Privacy & security** workshop saw AI researchers and corporate leaders — including **Jesse Cresswell** of **TD**, **Juan-Carlos Castañeda** of **Accenture**, **Areeb Khawaja** of **Telus**, and Vector's **Masoumeh Shafieinejad** and **Gautam Kamath** — explore a range of issues, including the benefits and risks of using synthetic data to train models; the challenges involved in using private data instead of large public datasets; moving privacy-enhancing technologies from research into industry; the limits of membership inference attacks to monitor LLM use of copyrighted material; and the competing priorities involved in building trustworthy AI.



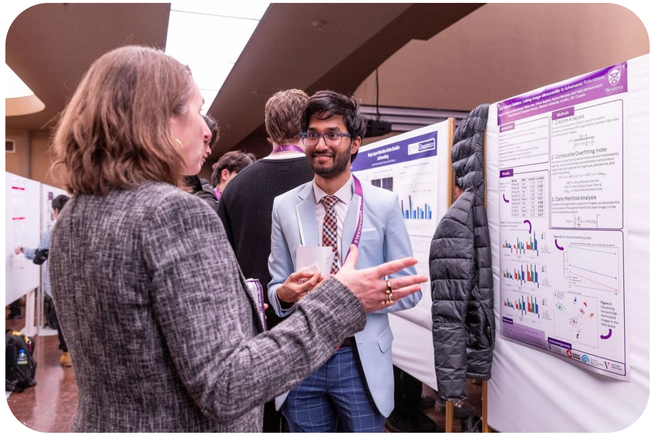
3. Frontiers of LLMs

The **Frontiers of LLMs** workshop featured Vector Faculty Member **Xiaodan Zhu**, **Arash Afkanpour** from Vector's Machine Learning team, and **Mrinal Tirkha** of **Deloitte**, coming together to tackle critical deployment challenges facing organizations moving from LLM experimentation to practical implementation. Sessions covered LLM "certainty" manipulation, ACE evaluation framework for "Scientist Models" in handling complex tasks, and addressing enterprise adoption barriers through AI reasoning with human validation to bridge the "trust deficit" in business settings.

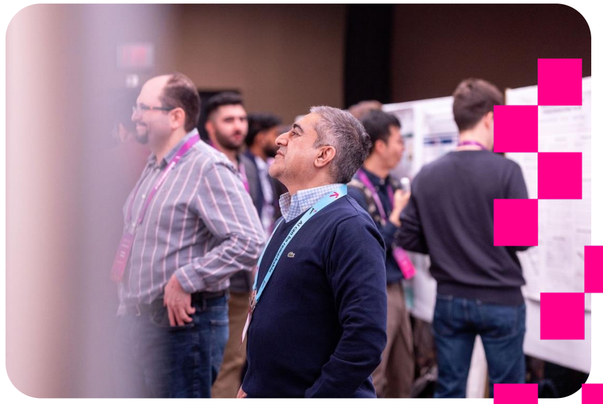


Day 2 February 20, 2026

The poster session showcased the next generation of AI innovation through 50+ presentations from across Vector’s research community, spanning critical societal challenges including: health care and medical AI, which saw breakthroughs in voice-controlled surgical navigation, cancer detection, and clinical decision support systems; AI safety and responsible AI, with work on bias detection across demographics and dialects, privacy preservation techniques, and fairness optimization;
and foundation model innovations, exploring efficiency improvements, multimodal capabilities, and novel architectures for next-generation language and vision systems. The diverse portfolio demonstrated Canadian AI leadership from Toronto-based optimization startups to Vector's medical AI pipeline, positioning Canada as a hub for health care AI innovation and sustainable technology development.







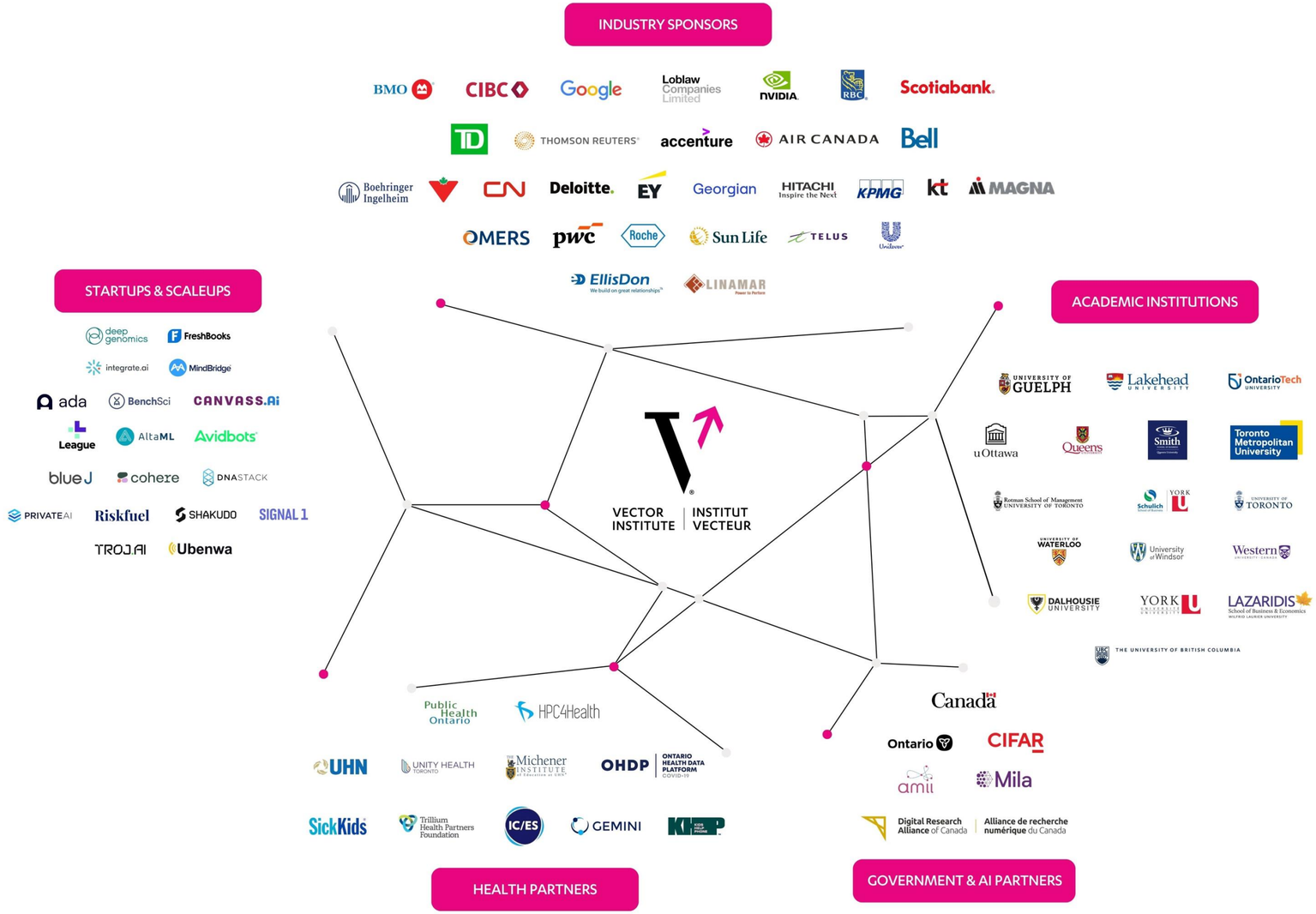
THANK YOU TO OUR FUNDERS

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CIFAR

THANK YOU TO OUR ECOSYSTEM PARTNERS



Thank you for being part of Remarkable 2026 and our thriving Vector community, over 10,000 strong. Your participation and insights have made this conference a catalyst for the innovations that will define tomorrow.

As our valued partners in Canada's AI ecosystem, you understand the significance of this moment and the opportunities before us. The connections forged here — between disciplines, sectors, and visionaries — will continue generating breakthroughs long after we've left these halls. Together, we're not just witnessing the future of AI; we're actively building it.

The conversations continue, the collaborations deepen, and Canada's influence on the global AI landscape grows stronger.

To connect with our leadership team, contact marcomm@vectorinstitute.ai


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